

TEXTJOIN Function in Excel

1. What is TEXTJOIN?

The TEXTJOIN function joins text from several cells or a whole range, puts a separator of your choice between the items, and can skip empty cells. It solves the problem of combining many values into one clean piece of text, such as a list of names or a full address. A Data Analyst uses it to merge columns and build lists without extra commas or gaps from blank cells.

2. Syntax

=TEXTJOIN(delimiter, ignore_empty, text1, [text2], ...)

Argument	Required?	What it accepts
delimiter	Required	The separator placed between items, in quotes: ", " - ", or "" for no separator. A cell reference also works.
ignore_empty	Required	TRUE skips empty cells. FALSE keeps them. Do not put quotes around TRUE or FALSE.
text1	Required	The text, cell, or range to join (for example A2:C2)
text2, ...	Optional	More text, cells, or ranges to join

The delimiter appears only between items, never at the start or end. Unlike CONCAT, TEXTJOIN adds the separator for you, so you do not repeat it in the formula.

3. Simple Example

Join names with a comma, ignoring blank cells:

	A	B	C	D
1	Name 1	Name 2	Name 3	Result
2	Rahim	Khan	Ali	Rahim, Khan, Ali
3	Karim		Hasan	Karim, Hasan
4	Nabil	Hossain		Nabil, Hossain
5	Sadia	Rahman	Rafi	Sadia, Rahman, Rafi

Formula in D2: =TEXTJOIN(", ", TRUE, A2:C2), then copied down to D5.

Excel joins the three cells in A2:C2 with ", " between them. In row 3, the blank cell B3 is skipped because ignore_empty is TRUE. **Result:** Karim, Hasan

4. Another Example

Put all products from a list into one cell (row 4 is blank):

	A
1	Product
2	Mouse
3	Keyboard
4	
5	Monitor
6	Headset
7	Mouse, Keyboard, Monitor, Headset

Formula in A7: =TEXTJOIN(", ", TRUE, A2:A6)

Excel joins the products down the column in order. The blank cell A4 is skipped. With FALSE instead of TRUE, the result would have an extra comma: "Mouse, Keyboard, , Monitor, Headset".

5. When to Use It

- Merge name parts into one name, skipping any that are blank
- Build a comma-separated list of products, customers, or items in one cell
- Build an address from street, area, and city when some parts are missing
- Create labels such as "Product - Category - Price" from several columns
- Combine tags, skills, or notes from multiple columns into one

6. Important Things to Remember

- The first argument is the delimiter and the second is TRUE or FALSE. Both must come before the text.
- TRUE skips empty cells. FALSE keeps them, which creates extra delimiters, such as "Karim, , Hasan".
- TEXTJOIN accepts ranges across a row or down a column, so you do not have to list each cell.
- The result is text. Numbers are joined as stored: 1200 stays 1200, not 1,200.
- The result cannot be longer than 32,767 characters, or Excel shows #VALUE!.
- TEXTJOIN is available in Excel 2019, Excel 2021, and Microsoft 365, but not in Excel 2016 or earlier.

7. Common Mistakes

Mistake: Leaving out the ignore_empty argument, such as =TEXTJOIN(", ", A2:C2). **Fix:** Always include TRUE or FALSE as the second argument.

Mistake: Using FALSE by accident, so blank cells leave extra commas in the result. **Fix:** Use TRUE unless you want blank cells to be kept.

Mistake: Typing the delimiter without quotation marks, such as =TEXTJOIN(-, TRUE, A2:C2). **Fix:** Write the delimiter in quotes: "-".

Mistake: Joining dates and seeing serial numbers such as 46023. **Fix:** Convert the date with the TEXT function first, for example TEXT(A2, "dd-mmm-yyyy").

8. Data Analyst Tip

Use TEXTJOIN with a whole column to build a quick list for a report or an email, for example =TEXTJOIN(", ", TRUE, A2:A50). Keep ignore_empty set to TRUE so that blank rows do not create extra commas. If you need to keep the result after changing the source data, copy it and paste as values.